

Nessus: A Powerful Tool for Vulnerability Assessment.

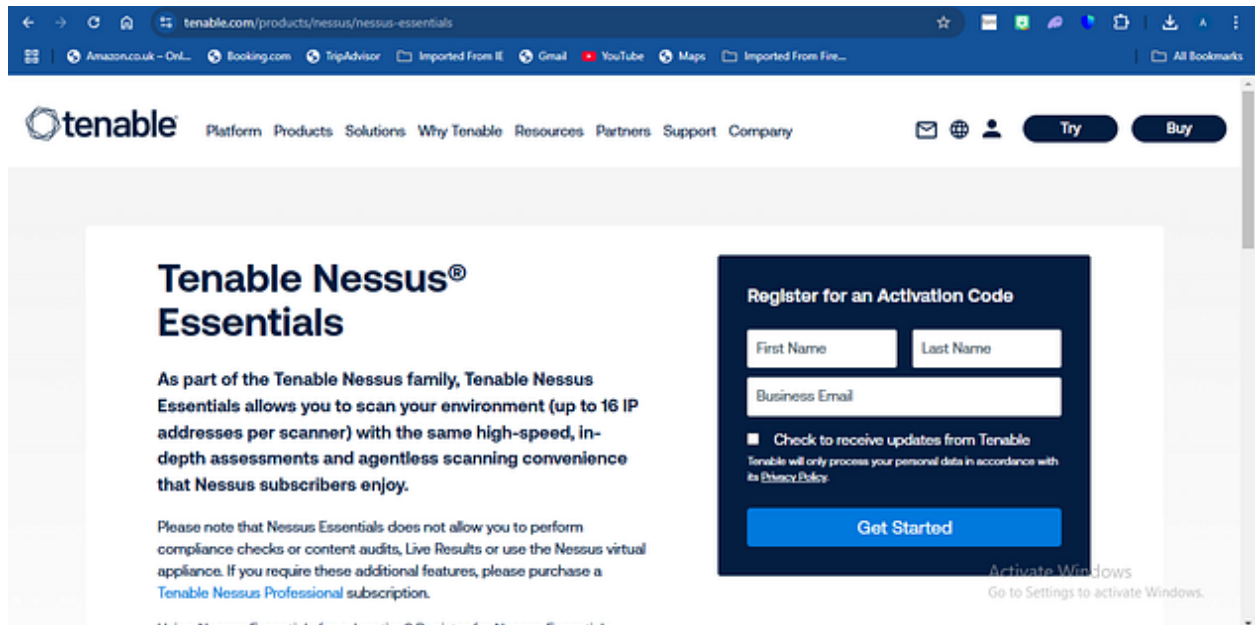
Nessus is a widely used vulnerability scanner developed by Tenable that helps security professionals identify and remediate vulnerabilities in systems, networks, and applications. It scans for misconfigurations, missing patches, weak passwords, and potential security risks. Nessus supports various compliance checks, penetration testing, and asset discovery, making it essential for vulnerability assessment and risk management.

Nessus Installation Process

1. Download Nessus

- Visit the [official Tenable website](#).
- Select the appropriate version: **Nessus Essentials** (free for personal use) or **Nessus Professional** (paid). However, this installation guide is focused on **Nessus Essentials**.
- Choose your OS: Windows, Linux, or macOS.

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You will then Register, the registration should be done with your work email and not the regular Gmail, because it MIGHT not allow any other type besides work email, if you don't have a work email, register protonmail and use instead, that's where your activation code will be sent to.

2. Install Nessus

After the download is completed, installation is just like every other software installation on the computer, select "I agree" to the license agreement, and click on "Next" on every other prompt you get.

- For **Windows**: Run the downloaded .exe file and follow the installation wizard/prompt.
- For **Linux**: Run the following command in the terminal:
 - `sudo dpkg -i Nessus-<version>.deb` # Debian-based
 - `sudo rpm -i Nessus-<version>.rpm` # RHEL-based

- For **macOS**: Open the `.dmg` file and drag the Nessus application to the Applications folder.

3. Start Nessus Service

- **Windows**: Nessus starts automatically after installation.
- **Linux/macOS**: Start Nessus manually:
- `sudo systemctl start nessusd`

4. Access Nessus Web Interface

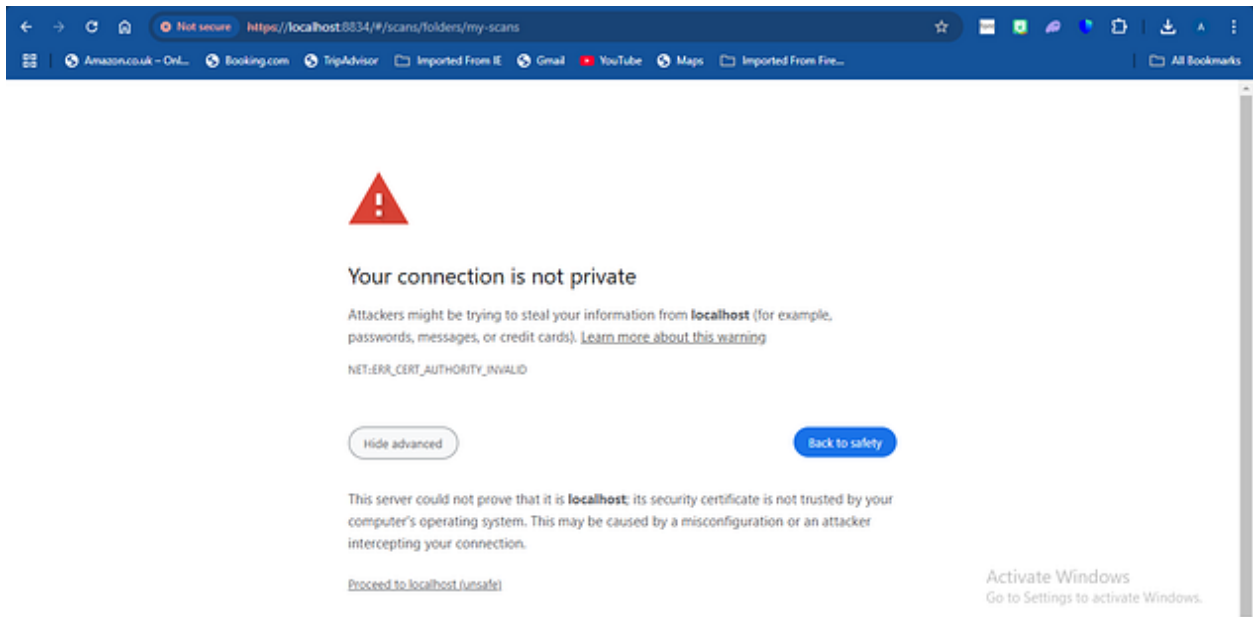
The nessus software will then open your browser, when it does you'd see (localhost 8834) on the url bar after that is done, it will display Nessus page and connect via SSL, select the "Connect via ssl" option, it'd then redirect you to another page where it says advance option on the left side of your screen, click on advance and continue, wait for few seconds or minutes, then select nessus essentials

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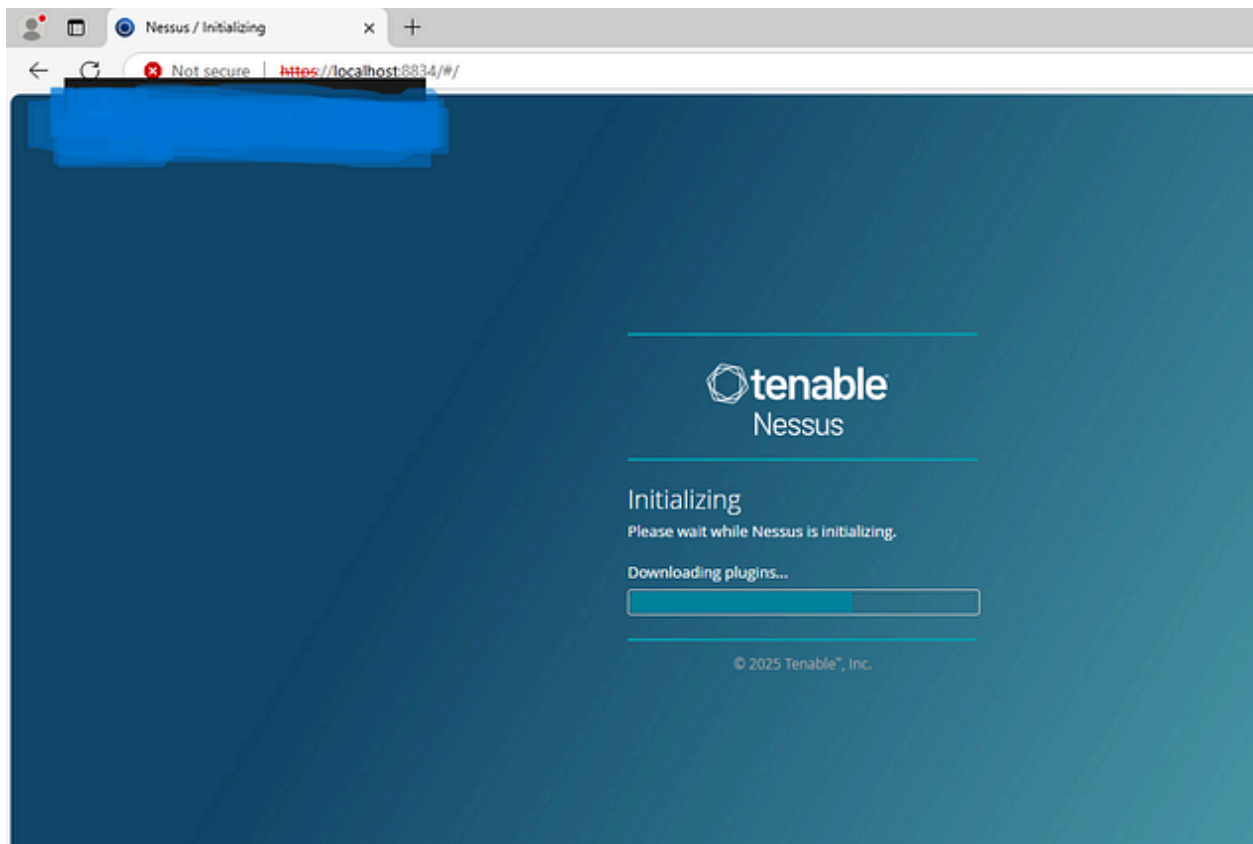
Click on Advanced

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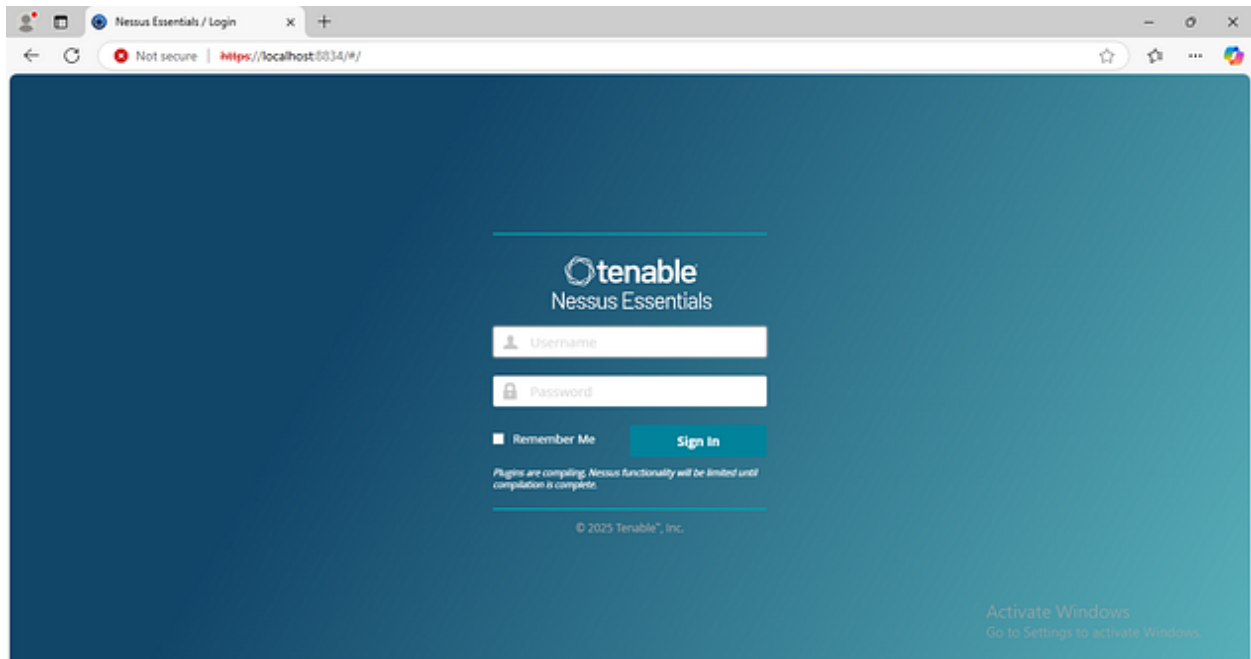
Click on Proceed to localhost (unsafe)

Press enter or click to view image in full size



- Open a browser and go to:
- <https://localhost:8834>
- Create an account and enter the activation code received from Tenable.
- Nessus will download and install necessary plugins automatically.

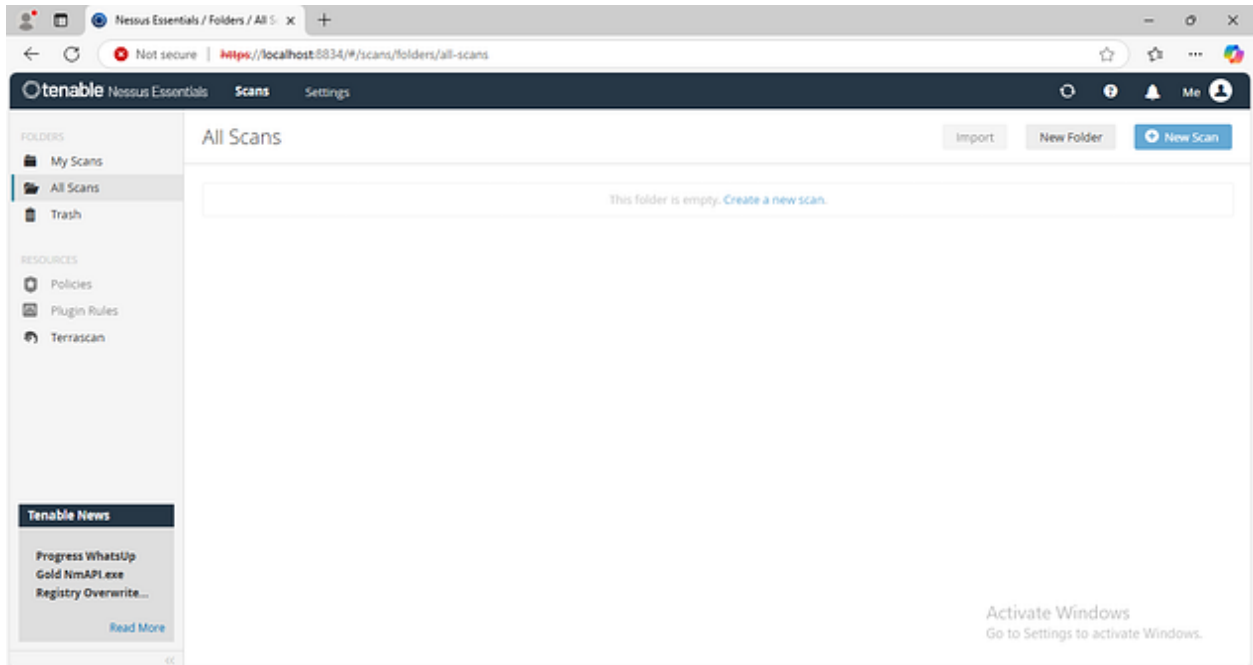
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5. Start Scanning

- Log in to the Nessus dashboard.

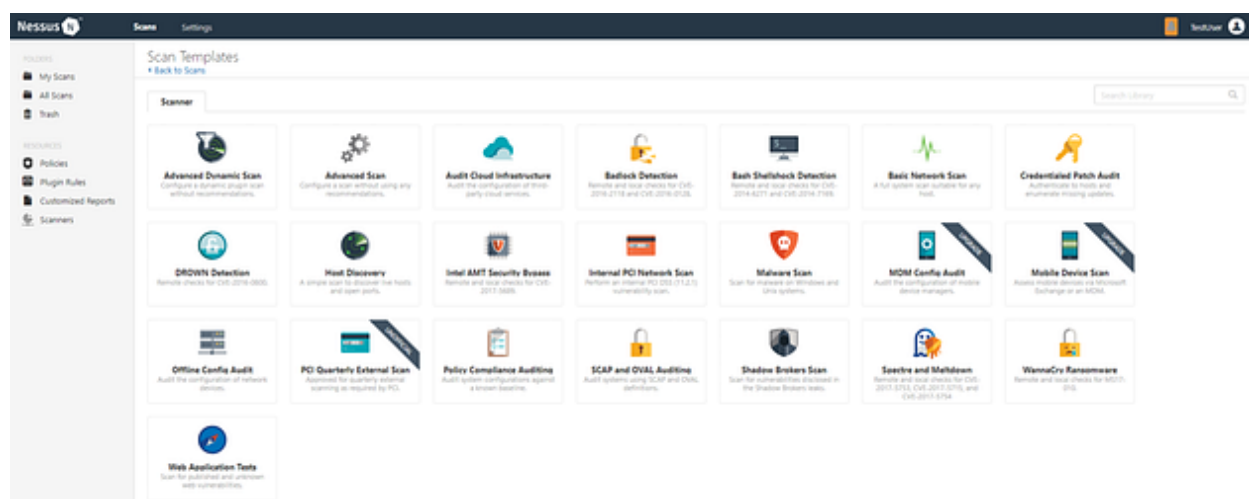
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The Scan environment on Nessus

It will be blank at first and that is because it is compiling the downloaded plugins, once it is done, you will see other scan templates you can select from just like in the image below.

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Scan Templates

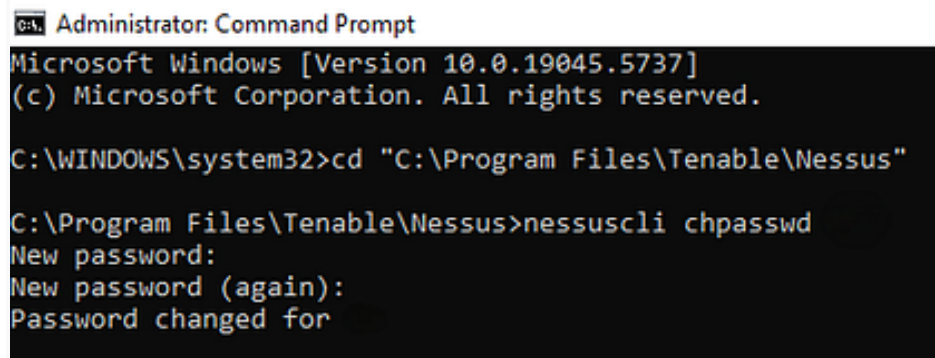
- Create a new scan, select the scan template, configure the target, and start scanning.

However, I encountered a common problem, so after a few months of writing this article, I realized I should include it, and that's the issue of forgotten password. It's not on the GUI, but that doesn't mean it can't be changed. Here's how to do it: Go to your system search bar and type CMD, then run it as an administrator. When the terminal/command line screen pops up, type this in the command line

"C:\Program Files\Tenable\Nessus" (If that is the file path to where the content of the Nessus files are located on your computer))

Hit enter, then type

nessuscli chpasswd (Your Username)



```
C:\> Administrator: Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.19045.5737]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\WINDOWS\system32>cd "C:\Program Files\Tenable\Nessus"

C:\Program Files\Tenable\Nessus>nessuscli chpasswd
New password:
New password (again):
Password changed for
```

Command prompt

Hit enter again and retype for confirmation, then the final enter, and you are good to go. Do not reinstall or uninstall before you try this. If it works for you, then you don't need to uninstall or reinstall it at all. If you do, you will need to re-register, and that's because the activation key will no longer be active.